through non-military means, including diplomacy and international arbitration. The UN Security Council (UNSC) has long been the premier forum for deliberating and deciding important matters of peace and security, but its effectiveness has grown more questionable due to its composition, its lack of implementation, and the frequent use of the veto by three of the five permanent members. Other institutions have grown to complement the UNSC, from informal groups, regional organizations, international legal and arbitration bodies, and security groupings. India is party to several institutions and treaties that govern security matters, including the Conference on Disarmament, the Chemical and Biological Weapons Conventions (CWC and BWC), the Geneva Conventions that cover wartime acts, and the International Court of Justice.

For New Delhi, arms control measures have been a major preoccupation due to India's development of nuclear weapons. This placed India at odds with the institutional cornerstones of global non-proliferation. As India has begun to normalize its nuclear arsenal, including through a waiver by the Nuclear Suppliers Group that allowed other countries to engage in civilian nuclear commerce with India, it has gradually become incorporated into other arms control mechanisms and export control groups. These have included the Missile Technology Control Regime (MTCR), the Wassenaar Arrangement (that controls exports of conventional military and dual-use technologies), and the Australia Group (the controls exports of chemical and biological weapons). India's entry into the Nuclear Suppliers Group, which would give it a vote and voice in determining nuclear exports, has so far been blocked by China.

A second set of institutions and arrangements are responsible for managing the global commons. These include parts of the world that are ungoverned or ungovernable by sovereign states. By their very nature, global commons tend to be overused without any individual country bearing responsibility for upkeep and sustainability. [3] In practice, the global commons might include the oceans, outer space, polar regions, the atmosphere, and by some reckonings cyber space. Governance of the oceans is based on the United Nations Convention on the Law of the Sea